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Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau · April 29 · 🌐

What is the history of the old house in Colchester, Connecticut?

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Saw this from a distance and my chin dropped. Got a little closer for some quick snaps. What a house! Colchester. Anyone have history on this beautiful old lady?





1K

99



25



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What people are saying

The Henry Champion House, built around 1790, features federal-style architecture and a notable history, with current owners restoring the interior and yard after years of disrepair.

All comments ▼

**Caylei Rae Arnold**

Always been an amazing house. Could use a little love

15w

7

**Marilyn Bednarz Barnett**

Caylei Rae Arnold it's been getting love since it was sold a couple of years ago. Changes in landscape and I've seen contractor trucks there as well. I would guess at some point we see some freshening up in the exterior paint.

15w

8

**Kate Avery**

Marilyn Bednarz Barnett ah I am SO happy to hear that! I've admired it for years. I hate that they tore down the Greek revival kittycorner to put up that ridiculous oversized gas station abomination.

15w

2

**Kate Avery**

I wonder if they've found any pottery sherds or other interesting artifacts while doing the landscaping? I'd give anything to see what they've found.

15w

2

**Troy LaPointe** Moderator

Beautiful house, love the roofline

15w

2

**Eva Doll**

I love this house! It's so beautiful. I don't live too far from it, and always want to explore it every time I drive by.

15w

6

**Mary Lang Killilea**

Champion house

15w

8

**David Malloy**

Mary Lang Killilea yup, the Champion family

15w

2

**Barbara Coyle**

The most beautiful raised paneling I've ever seen.
Fabulous ENORMOUS olde kitchen fireplace as well as many others. Beautiful wide board floor.
A stunning home.

15w

15  **Liz Bengtson**

Barbara Coyle did you notice when you toured that in the front formal rooms the woodwork over the fireplace is angled. We were told it was to emulate a ship.

15w

6   **Barbara Coyle**

Liz Bengtson Not sure what you mean by angled. Was it titled toward the fireplace wall?
Fascinating 

15w

**Liz Bengtson**

Barbara Coyle the wood work on either side of the mantle is a slightly angled down. It's not the house sinking because it's symmetrical. It is said to be due to William Spratt the architect being a ship builder architect.

15w

2 **Barbara Coyle**

Liz Bengtson That is really cool ...
I did not notice that. I pray the house found a good Steward. 

15w

1 **Liz Bengtson**

Barbara Coyle me too!

15w

1 **Liz Bengtson**

Barbara Coyle did you know there's a matching fireplace in the basement?

15w

2 **Barbara Coyle**

Liz Bengtson I can't remember the basement but those fireplaces are amazing. The olde kitchen fireplace has an enormous hearth.

15w

1 

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**Liz Bengtson**

Barbara Coyle in the basement there is a matching fireplace and a well! There were bars on the small windows, my dad saved them ind put them in one window(that's all were left)

15w

2

**Frances Sampson**

Nice!!!

15w

2

**Margery Dempsey Bogus**

quote wikipedia "The Henry Champion House is a historic house on Westchester Road in Colchester, Connecticut, built in 1790. It is a good example of Federal period architecture, designed by architect William Sprat. It was built by Colonel Henry Champion, a commissary leader during the American Revolutionary War, for his son General Henry Champion. The house was listed on the National Register of Historic Places in 1972"

15w

40

**D Steven Bradstreet**

Henry Champion house. Was really run down and went up for auction. Bought about one year ago, I understand by distant relatives of the Champions. Working on restoring interior (which was badly abused by prior occupants) and yard. It's getting there!

15w

42

**Nancy Jobbagy**

D Steven Bradstreet I am so happy to hear that distant relatives are saving this very special historical home. What beautifully unusual lines to this home. I would love to see the finished renovation.

15w

9

**Megan Quinn Cantin**

Glad someone is giving it love! Was on the market a long time. Needs a lot of work

14w

1

**Barbara Naughton**

There was a real estate listing exposing the interior when it was for sale. Pretty amazing. Will require a considerable amount of work to update.

15w

1

**Ben Haley**

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**David Shaw**

Beautiful house. My mother's family was from Colchester - Taintor name.

15w

**Kathleen Ryan**

David Shaw are you related to the Taintors who built the house on the corner of Bulkeley Bill and Route 16??

15w

**David Shaw****Kathleen Ryan** Yes, directly descended from Newhall Taintor to Ralph Smith Taintor and my great grandmother who was Ruth Smith Taintor who married Elisha Wolcott Welles of Wethersfield. My mother was Ruth Taintor Hubbard.

15w

**Kathleen Ryan**

David Shaw Roger Taintor, I believe was the builder of the house.

15w

**Lisa Sauer**

Beautiful house. Used to have a historic plaque out front with some of the history but over the years it seems to have disappeared. The house got really run down for a while but looks better now. I am sure it is a lot to keep up. Hopefully its new owners can give it the love it deserves.

15w

**Liz Bengtson**

Lisa Sauer the blue oval was the designation the national registry of historic homes

15w

**Marge Kuhl**

Absolutely beautiful!

15w

**Kathleen Ryan****Liz Bengtson** more love for your former home! 🥰

15w

**Beth Brooks Cunningham**

Yes!! I have been inside this house and it's amazing!

15w



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**Liz Bengtson**

My family owned it in the 60 through the 80s. Most of my mother's decorating have been left unchanged since the 60s.

15w

16   **Gail Liscio**

She is most definitely a beauty!!! I have a feeling that the original house was the small portion behind the larger structure due to the huge stone foundation.

15w

1 **Liz Bengtson**

Gail Liscio we were told the back wings were the additions. Between that hallway and what we use as a family member but was the original kitchen there were windows over one of the doors, indicating that it had been an outside door at one point.

15w

2 **Dan Rowland**

Should make an attempt to put it on the National Register of Historical Places, if Harry's can do it so can the 1790 Champion House.

15w

2  **Liz Bengtson**

Dan Rowland it was in the '70. Not sure you lose it...

15w

4 **Dan Rowland**

May try contacting them for a new plaque

15w

2 **Liz Bengtson**

Dan Rowland my family owned it in the 70s and 80s no longer in charge of that I wish I knew the people to relay that to!

15w

1 **Kathleen Ryan**

Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau - the family of my dear friend **Liz Bengtson**, who I tagged here, lived in and did major renovation and restoration to this house from ~ 1969-1990-something. Spent many happy hours in that house. Liz can of course tell you much more. What's sad is that after her parents downsized and moved, the house once again fell into disrepair. Also, on the south side of the house that you didn't see is a beautiful glassed sun porch (that I'm sure had to have been an addition, but lovely nonetheless) that was the site of many parties during our high

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Liz Bengtson
Kathleen Ryan ❤️

15w



Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau [Author](#)

Kathleen Ryan I saw the sun porch. I drove all around it trying to get a better view!

15w



Craig Lewis Cowing
I've been by it and drool every time !

15w



Kenneth Langdon Oakes

Attached is a picture of my great grandfathers house...the Langdons which was located in Kensington unfortunately over the years they tore it down...



15w



Liz Bengtson
Kenneth Langdon Oakes what a shame we've lost so many beautiful homes.I was just in the area of Kensington and saw some gorgeous old houses

15w



Beth Hollman

Kenneth Langdon Oakes Any chance you are a descendent of Daniel Landon (1650) of Farmington/Bristol RI who was a descendent of George Langdon of Northampton, Mass? They are my direct ancestors. In fact, my youngest son is named after Daniel. His story is fascinating.

I love Kensington. I've drive through there often taking my son to work. Lots of beautiful houses. Your great grandfather's house was huge! Beautiful. I love the porch. 📷

14w

**Kenneth Langdon Oakes**

Beth Hollman the Langdons immigrated to Farmington CT around 1639...I think Joseph Langdon was the first one..one of his kids Dwight Langdon and other members of the family relocated to Unionville and Dwight founded a Nut & Bolt factory along the river and he died young and his brother in law took it over and it became very successful...the brick building is painted white and still there...the used to call Unionville Langdons Quarter...other members of the family relocated Captain John Langdon relocated to Kensington and were major land owners...I am not sure if we are related

14w

**Meryl Smith**

My grandmother's grandmother owned the house in the early 1900s, when my gram was a young child! It's so beautiful. My grandmother is the cutie with the braids on the left of the photo.



15w

18  **Meryl Smith**

From a family album



15w

9  **Liz Bengtson**

Meryl Smith I have never seen that picture!

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**Jon Curtis**

Meryl Smith - When the Widow's Walk was still there. Rumor was one could see to the coast on a clear day but who knows?

15w

**Liz Bengtson**

Meryl Smith Meryl I had a wedding picture taken in that spot! Maybe I was tossing the bouquet?

15w

**Betty Loomis Price**

Meryl Smith I have pictures of my brothers and I sitting in that same spot! Time would have been the late 50's early 60's.

15w

**Meryl Smith**

Betty Loomis Price I want to say this picture was the mid to late 1930's, based on my gram's age.

15w

**Grzegorz Dawidowicz** [Admin](#)

Great looking old house!

15w

**Jon Curtis**

Betty Loomis Price - what years did your family own the house. Many fond memories visiting your family there and later, **Liz Bengtson** and family.

15w

**Betty Loomis Price**

Jon Curtis my grandfather bought the house in the 40's. I have pictures of my mother standing in the yard , holding my oldest brother Ralph who was a baby at the time...that would be around 1944-45. My mother joked with her dad , saying the house was big enough for her to move in with her family...little did she know! The house was sold to Liz's family a few years after he passed away in the late 60's. So many memories growing up in that house!

15w

**Jon Curtis**

Betty Loomis Price - I think Ralph was in Art's class at Bacon ('62) so '44-'45 would be right.

15w



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15w

1 

Elizabeth Kaminski
Wow...I love this house!!

15w

1 

Lynn Denison
Henry Champion House! It's beautiful, and he owned the Lake down the street as well,.

15w



Liz Bengtson
Lynn Denison interesting I had never heard that!

15w



Kelsey Elizabeth
It was up for auction a few years ago. It definitely needed some pretty extensive work from the listing photos. It looks like the new owners have been working to fix it up!

15w

1 

Kim Westcote Watts
I thought this house looked very familiar. It was along my bus route as a kid. Bus 1.


15w

1 

Bev Yelle
What a beautiful old home....

15w



Ethan Stone
I just found a picture of my relatives house in Beverly mass that was built in 1680 and torn down in 1898. It looks very similar

15w



Hadrian Daile
Well, an issue with stool parasites.

15w



Johannah Faurot Aiken
I believe this interior picture falls under, "Fair Use". I found it on Google Images. There are many interior photos, such as the one below, that came via the listing, last time the Champion House was sold. William Raveis Real Estate. For educational purposes and to greatly appreciate the artistry of architect William Sprat. Per **Wikipedia** It was funded by Colonel Henry Champion, a commissary leader during

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15w 11   **David W Cyr**

General Champion house delivered beef to colonial troops during valley forge suffering hard winter conditions

15w

4 **Lise Danzer-Blaise**

Cool roofline! It's curved!

15w

**Nancy Wing**

Beautiful period home !

15w

**Liz Bengtson**

Nancy Wing Nancy, do you know where your WING family comes from? My grandmothers last name was Wing. Part of the family came from Sandwich, Massachusetts the Cape. ~~OBJ~~ there is a Wing Family museum there. My grandmother's family was from Maine,

2w

1 **Louise Fournier Perry**

Gorgeous!

15w

**Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau** [Author](#)

Louise Fournier Perry yes I would say it's graceful

15w

2 **Mike Carbonneau**

Tried to figure out a way to buy it back in the 1990s. It was kind of amazing, but even back then it was a project.

A very nice young couple owned it, and they made a go of running a store for french antiques, but when it proved unsuccessful you could see that trying to sell it and get back to normality was killing them. I sometimes think of their situation, and hope

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**Liz Bengtson**

Mike Carbonneau my family sold it to them about 1985

2w

**Dayle Wilder**

It's a Dutch Colonial

15w

**Donald Carleton**

Dayle Wilder Not really.

15w

**Mike Carbonneau**

It has a sort of mansard roof like Dutch Colonials do, but then it kind of has more of a Federalist Colonial thing going on too. A more eclectic design than usual for the time.

15w

**Paul Bourdon**

Beautiful House! Roofline looks to have Dutch influence?

15w

**Maryellen Wnek-woods**

Another beauty that is such an amazing looking House I wish I could see the inside

14w

**Kathryn Myers**

what a beautiful profile!

14w

**Hilary Peruti DiPiero**

This is beautiful ! This question is not related but since this house is in Colchester i thought i would ask. Ive been trying to find some family history on the parents of Thaddeus Morgan who was married to Anna Bigelow .It is documented that Thaddeus was born/from Colchester in 1778 . I cant seem to verify who his parents are and assume they lived in Colchester since thats where he was born. If this question isn't appropriate for this site just let me know and Im happy to remove it 😊 Thankyou .

14w

**Patricia Rutka**

I grew up in this house many years ago. The "Old Loomis homestead"!!!

14w



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Liz Bengtson
Patricia Rutka I did too!

14w



Betty Loomis Price
Patricia Rutka I also grew up in this house. I was told the Loomis homestead was across the street on Loomis Road...it was moved many years ago.

14w



Jane Moorhead
Construction: Built around 1790, the house is a prominent example of Federal-style architecture.
Significance: It was the home of General Henry Champion, a notable figure in Connecticut history.
Design Details: The structure features a distinctive "summer kitchen" wing and a matching fireplace located in the basement.

14w



Randy Fuller
Love this house!

14w



Liz Bengtson



14w



Liz Bengtson
My mother had two paintings done when we lived there. The most interesting one I think is of the back of the house. It shows you the additions on the back.

14w 4  **Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau** Author

Liz Bengtson wow that's amazing to see the back side which I was dying to see but could not see from the road. 4 chimneys!! 🤩

14w

2  **Ron Fournier**

From the Colchester Historical Society pages

<https://www.colchesterhistory.org/.../the-story-of-the.../> ✓



COLCHESTERHISTORY.ORG

The Story of the Champion Family of Colchester, CT

14w 4 **Bambi McGoff Stone**

I love this house! One of my favorites

14w

3 **Morgan Gruss**

This was my old boss's house, I've been inside many times. It is gorgeous!

14w

1 **Anna Sullivan**

I slept over this house in the early 2010s a handful of times, and it was creepy as all get out but such gorgeous bones and character. Kitchen was unfortunate as the previous renovators put in a 70s galley style kitchen but was probably the only move at their time of renovation. The back room which was the original kitchen still had the huge original fireplace which was probably 9 ft across. It was a lot of additions and the floorplan was interesting because of it. Still had the second set of stairs for staff to go up to their space. I hope to see pictures when it's all done!

14w

1 

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14w



Liz Bengtson

Anna Sullivan the kitchen was done by my parents in the 60s. They kept the Butler's pantry with as much of the old cabinets they could, but there was nothing left to Restore in the kitchen.

14w

Kristin Weingartner Bourbeau [Author](#)

It thrills me to get over 1000 "reactions". I knew this one was a winner and it briefly took my breath when I first laid eyes upon it!

14w



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Tom Marshall · 1d ·



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Steve Packard

I love these beautiful old churches in New England.
But spiritually speaking, they are long dead.
The spirit of revival, and fiery preaching that many of them were known for, when
they were built, is just history past.... **See more**

1d

Grzegorz Dawidowicz Admin

1d

1



Tom Marshall

Author

Madison Ct

1d

2

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3 of 5



Connecticut Old Churches Houses Bridges Mills

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Troy LaPointe

Moderator

2h

Historic colonial house with unique window configuration in West Simsbury, Connecticut

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Historic colonial built in 1785 in West Simsbury, Connecticut. Very interesting window configuration. I will post another angle of the home in the comment section.





56

8 

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Jane Jones

One can imagine what the little door window was for during the times. Husband away at war, wife and mother peering out with rifle in hand, to see if it was friend or foe at the door. Or else a very high cat door! Wonderful image and house.

1h

1 
- 

Lori Richardson

Love this color, unusual door config. Great side shot!

2h

1 
- 

Pamela Palmer

Where in WS?

1h

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3 of 7



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Rich Discoveries · 1h · 

Historic 1800s feed and grain store preserved in Fairfield, Connecticut

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This was an 1800s feed and grain store in Fairfield Connecticut that closed in the 1970s but the current owners keep its historic appearance all these years later. So many places like this were demolished for new housing, its nice to see some preserved



35

3

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- 

Suzanne Johnson
Got our bunny's pellets there for 8 years.
47m
- 

Grzegorz Dawidowicz Admin
Great find!
1h



Jack Bradley
We use to get duck food there
1h

